

THE EMBEDDED ENGINEER, FOR RECRUITERS

Recruit Assist — Offer Architecture

One trained assistant who runs your outreach, your sourcing, or both — with our systems behind them. **This document is canonical.** If the flyer, the landing page or a sales call says something different, this wins.

01 The offer on one page

RECRUIT ASSIST · AT A GLANCE	
WHAT IT IS	A trained recruitment assistant working only for your desk , running your outreach and/or your sourcing, using our systems and campaign stack — recruited, trained and managed by us.
WHO IT'S FOR	Independent recruitment, staffing and search firms, roughly 1–20 heads, where the owner or the billers are still doing their own BD <i>and</i> their own sourcing.
THE CORE PROBLEM	The 360 whipsaw. You do BD when the desk is quiet, stop when it gets busy, then the pipeline dries up three months later. Nobody can run both sides of a desk properly at the same time.
THE PROMISE	Split the desk without splitting your billings. One assistant takes a side — or most of both — so BD never stops when delivery gets loud.
OFFER 1 · PILLARS 1+2	Win The Work — outreach and presence. LinkedIn conversations, cold email campaigns, follow-up, adverts, content, the collateral that makes the outreach land.
OFFER 2 · PILLARS 3+4	Fill The Work — sourcing and desk operations. Mapping, longlists, headhunting outreach, screening prep, CV formatting, scheduling, ATS hygiene.
BOTH TOGETHER	Recruit Assist — one assistant across the full desk, or two specialists, one per side.
PRICE	\$1,500 per month, per assistant. One assistant on either half, or split across both. Two assistants — one per side — is \$3,000/mo. No salary, employer costs, payroll, software licences or recruitment risk.
POSITIONED AGAINST	A resourcer on payroll and a \$100K ops hire — never a freelance VA. \$18,000 a year against roughly \$70,000 fully loaded for a resourcer, or \$100,000+ for an ops hire.
DELIVERY MODEL	Same embedded model as our Embedded Engineer offer: a real person, ~40 hrs/week, on your desk, managed by us so you get output rather than a management job.
TERMS	90-day terms. Replacement if the fit is wrong. Buy-out path if you want them in-house.
GUARANTEE	No pipeline guarantee. This is a capacity offer, not a go-to-market one. The guarantee lives on The Unreplaceable Recruiter.

02 The problem, in recruiter language

Every 360 recruiter runs the same cycle, and every one of them knows it's happening while it happens.

The desk is quiet, so you do BD. BD works, so you win roles. Roles need filling, so you stop doing BD and go into delivery. You fill them, you bill, it's a good month. Then eight weeks later the pipeline is empty, because **nobody was doing BD while you were sourcing** — and you start again from cold.

That cycle isn't a discipline problem and it isn't a time-management problem. It's structural. A 360 desk has two full-time jobs on it and one person, and whichever job is loudest that week wins. The billers who escape it do exactly one thing: **they get another pair of hands on one side of the desk.**

WHY THEY HAVEN'T ALREADY SOLVED IT

Because the two available options are both bad. **Hiring a resourcer** means a salary, employer costs, a desk, software seats, three months of ramp, and the real chance they don't work out — for a firm doing a few hundred thousand in GP, that's a genuine bet-the-quarter decision. **Hiring a freelance VA** means you get someone who's never seen an ATS, doesn't know what a spec call is, and needs you to build the process, write the training, and manage them daily. So most owners do neither, and keep spinning the plates.

What we actually hear on calls

- *“I only do BD when I've got nothing on, and by then it's already too late.”*
- *“I'm winning roles I don't have time to fill properly, so I'm turning work away or doing a bad job of it.”*
- *“I spend my evenings on the ATS because there's no time in the day.”*
- *“I've tried a VA. I spent more time managing them than they saved me.”*
- *“I can't justify £40k for a resourcer until I'm billing more, but I can't bill more without one.”*

That last one is the trap the offer exists to break, and it should be said back to prospects almost word for word.

They need capacity to grow and growth to afford capacity. A flat monthly fee with no employer costs and no ramp period is the only thing that resolves it.

03 The four pillars

Two halves, two pillars each — the same architecture as every other offer in the family, mapped onto the two sides of a recruitment desk.

PILLAR 1 · WIN THE WORK

OUTREACH

Client-side conversations, run daily and never paused.

LinkedIn connection campaigns and conversation management · cold email sequences built and sent · follow-up on every thread · inbound reply triage · meeting booking straight into your diary · CRM notes kept current so you walk into a spec call briefed.

PILLAR 2 · WIN THE WORK

PRESENCE

The collateral that makes the outreach land.

Job adverts written and posted · your website kept current · LinkedIn posts and company page · case studies and testimonials chased and written up · candidate and client mailers · the market updates that keep you visible between roles.

PILLAR 3 · FILL THE WORK

SOURCE

Finding the people, so you're spending your time talking to them.

Market mapping and longlists · boolean and x-ray search · LinkedIn Recruiter and job-board sourcing · headhunting outreach to passive candidates · candidate response handling · MPC and float lists built from your existing bench.

PILLAR 4 · FILL THE WORK

RUN THE DESK

Everything that eats the evening.

Screening prep and pre-qualification notes · CV formatting to your template · interview scheduling and confirmations · reference and compliance chasing · ATS and CRM hygiene · pipeline reporting so you can see the desk at a glance.

HOW TO SELL THE SPLIT

Ask one question: **“Which side of your desk is currently stopping the other one from happening?”**

If they can't do BD because delivery is loud → **Fill The Work**, so the sourcing comes off their plate and BD restarts. If they've got capacity but no roles → **Win The Work**, so outreach runs whether or not they're in the mood. If both are broken → the full desk. **Most owners diagnose themselves accurately within about ten seconds of being asked.**

04 The commercial argument

This is the heart of the offer and the comparison we want prospects making. **We are not competing with a freelance VA and we should never let the conversation land there.** We are competing with the two things a growing recruitment firm actually considers when it needs capacity.

OPTION A

A resourcer on payroll

- Salary, plus employer NI or payroll tax
- Pension, holiday, sick cover
- Desk, laptop, software seats
- Weeks to hire, ~3 months to ramp
- You write the training
- You manage them, daily
- If it doesn't work, you carry it

OPTION B

A \$100K ops hire

- Six figures all-in before tooling
- Needs a defined role to step into
- Generalist — not recruiting-native
- Long notice periods both ways
- A serious bet for a firm under 20 heads
- Still needs your systems built first

OPTION C

Recruit Assist

- ✓ One flat monthly fee
- ✓ No employer costs of any kind
- ✓ Trained on recruitment before day one
- ✓ Systems and tooling included
- ✓ Managed by us, not by you
- ✓ Replace them if the fit is wrong
- ✓ 90-day terms, buy-out path

THE LINE TO USE

“You're not comparing us to a VA. You're comparing us to the resourcer you can't quite justify yet, or the six-figure ops hire you're not ready for — at a fraction of either, with none of the employment risk and no ramp, because they're trained before they reach you.”

05 Price

WHAT THEY BUY	PER MONTH	WHAT IT COVERS
One assistant	\$1,500	One trained assistant, ~40 hrs/week, on either half — or splitting their week across both, if the desk needs a bit of each.
Two assistants	\$3,000	One dedicated to Win The Work , one to Fill The Work . The full desk, properly covered, with neither side ever waiting on the other.

One price, one unit. The price is per assistant, not per pillar — which keeps the conversation simple and lets the client decide where the hours go. If they want to start on one half and move the assistant later, that's a conversation, not a new contract.

THE COMPARISON, WITH THE MATHS STATED

\$1,500/mo is \$18,000 a year. A resourcer on a \$55,000 salary costs roughly **\$70,000 fully loaded** once employer taxes, pension, holiday, desk and software seats are counted — before three months of ramp. A \$100K ops hire is **\$100,000+** before tooling.

So: **about a quarter of a resourcer. Under a fifth of an ops hire.** Always state the assumptions when you use these figures — a recruiter will do the sum themselves, and being the one who showed the working is worth more than the ratio.

The two objections that actually come up

“I've had a VA before and it was more work than it saved.” Agree with them immediately — it's almost always true. Then draw the distinction: a general VA arrives with no context and you become their trainer and manager. Ours arrive already trained on recruitment process, already inside our systems, and **we manage them**. The difference isn't the person, it's everything wrapped around the person.

“How do I know they'll be any good?” They're recruited and vetted by us against a recruitment-specific bar, trained before they're assigned, and if the fit is wrong we replace them. The client never runs a hiring process, never writes a job spec, and never has to fire anyone.

06 How we talk about the team

STANDING RULE

We do not lead with where our assistants are recruited from, and no asset states a country. Not because there's anything to hide, but because naming a location invites a price-anchoring conversation and puts us straight back into the VA comparison we've just worked to escape. The value is the training, the systems and the management — not the geography.

If a prospect asks directly, answer honestly and move on. Deflecting a direct question costs far more trust than the answer costs. The reply is short and unapologetic: where they're based, followed immediately by how they're selected, trained and managed — which is the part that actually matters and the part competitors can't copy.

WHAT WE SAY INSTEAD, ON EVERY ASSET

- “Recruited, vetted and trained by us” — the process is the product.
- “Trained on recruitment before they reach your desk” — the direct answer to the bad-VA objection.
- “Managed by us — you get output, not a management job” — the single strongest line in the offer.
- “Working only on your desk” — distinguishes from pooled or shared-resource models.
- “Our systems and campaign stack included” — the reason one assistant can run multiple campaigns at once.

LIVE CONFLICT THAT NEEDS RESOLVING

The current Recruit Assist page argues explicitly **for** South African talent and **against** the Philippines on retention grounds, citing average tenure figures. If assistants are now recruited from the Philippines, that page is publicly making the case against our own supply. It needs to come down or be rewritten before this offer goes to market — a prospect who reads the old page and then hears a different answer on a call will disengage, and they'd be right to.

07 Where this sits against our other offers

OFFER	BUYS THEM	CHOOSE IT WHEN
Recruit Assist	Capacity	The desk is the constraint. They know what to do and have no time to do it.
The Unreplaceable Recruiter	Differentiation	They have capacity but sound like every other firm. Carries the \$50K/90-day guarantee.
The Embedded Engineer	Systems	Non-recruiting business — internal apps, operations, automation.
Fractional Go-to-Market	Pipeline	Non-recruiting business that needs a full go-to-market engine.

These are complementary, not competing. Recruit Assist and The Unreplaceable Recruiter are the natural pairing for a recruitment firm: one gives them the hours, the other gives them something worth saying with those hours. Lead with whichever the prospect names as their constraint, and mention the other only once the first is agreed.

08 Onboarding — the first 14 days

DAY	STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
1	Desk audit	60 minutes. Which side of the desk is blocked, what tools they run, what their process actually looks like, what "good" means on their desk.
2-4	Match and brief	We assign an assistant against that profile and brief them on the firm, the sectors, the tone and the tooling before the client meets them.
5	Introduction	Client meets their assistant. Access granted to ATS/CRM, LinkedIn, inbox and job boards. Shared channel opened.
6-10	Shadow and ship	First live work goes out — usually adverts, ATS clean-up and the first outreach campaign build, because they produce visible output fastest.
11-14	Cadence set	Daily written update, weekly review. Volume targets agreed. From here it runs, and we manage it.

THE ONBOARDING PROMISE WORTH MAKING ON THE PAGE

Live work inside two weeks, and the client never writes a job spec, never runs an interview process, and never has to train anyone. That's the whole difference between this and hiring, and it's the promise most likely to convert someone who has been putting off a resourcer hire for a year.

09 Open decisions

- 1 Price — decided.** \$1,500/mo per assistant, \$3,000 for two. Now live on the flyer, the offer spec and the landing page. Remaining question is whether a discount applies at two seats; currently it does not.
- 2 One assistant or two?** The copy currently says one can cover most of both halves. Worth confirming the realistic ceiling — overselling a single assistant's capacity is the fastest route to churn in month two.
- 3 Hours.** Stated as ~40/week. Confirm whether that's the standard and whether part-time is offered, because a smaller firm will ask.
- 4 Replacement terms.** "Replace if the fit is wrong" needs a defined window — 30 days is the conventional answer and it should be in writing.
- 5 The old page.** Decide whether the existing Recruit Assist site is rewritten or retired. See the conflict flagged in section 05.

Canonical offer document. Supersedes any earlier Recruit Assist description, including the live beta page. Recruit Assist is the recruiting-specific expression of the Embedded Engineer delivery model; it is a capacity offer and carries no pipeline guarantee. The \$50,000 / 90-day guarantee attaches only to The Unreplaceable Recruiter.